

D225

Emerging Professional Practice

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 58-year-old with newly diagnosed lung cancer is starting chemotherapy at a cancer center with a new infusion suite. She has severe pain and nausea. She is a high school principal. Which service can support her now?

- A. Hospice, since any cancer diagnosis qualifies
- B. Hospice, which would require stopping chemotherapy
- C. Palliative care, alongside her chemotherapy
- D. Neither, until curative treatment fails

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which patient meets typical Medicare hospice eligibility?

- A. A patient whose physician certifies a prognosis of six months or less and who chooses comfort-focused care
- B. A patient on curative chemotherapy who wants help with nausea
- C. Any patient over age 85
- D. A patient with a prognosis of about one year

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 30-year-old at a genetics clinic that recently hired a counselor has a father with Huntington disease, an autosomal dominant condition; her mother is unaffected. She works as a pilot. What is her chance of having inherited the variant?

- A. It depends on job-related exposures.
- B. 100%
- C. 50%
- D. 25%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A condition appears in every generation, affects males and females equally, and an affected parent passes it to about half of the children. Which inheritance pattern fits?

- A.** Mitochondrial
- B.** Autosomal dominant
- C.** X-linked recessive
- D.** Autosomal recessive

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Two parents who are both carriers of cystic fibrosis visit a clinic with a colorful new waiting area. They already have one healthy son. What is the chance their next child will have cystic fibrosis?

- A.** 75%
- B.** 50%
- C.** 0%, since they already had a healthy child
- D.** 25%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Two parents are both carriers of an autosomal recessive condition. What is the chance a child will be a carrier but not affected?

- A.** 25%
- B.** 75%
- C.** 100%
- D.** 50%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A patient with a strong family history of breast cancer who works at a tech startup asks whether genetic testing could affect her coverage. Her sister is a lawyer. Under GINA, what is protected?

- A. Health insurance and employment decisions; life, disability, and long-term care insurance are not covered.
- B. Every type of insurance
- C. Life insurance only
- D. Employment only

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A hospice patient at home in a neighborhood with a new park reports distressing breathlessness. The family has three dogs. The care plan is comfort-focused. Which approach aligns with palliative principles?

- A. Relieve the breathlessness with ordered comfort measures, such as prescribed opioids, positioning, and a fan, and reassess.
- B. Arrange transfer for intubation.
- C. Withhold opioids, since they always hasten death.
- D. Remove the dogs from the home.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A 75-year-old retired engineer at a clinic that offers free parking wants to name his daughter to make medical decisions if he loses capacity. He also plays chess daily. Which document does he need?

- A. A living will
- B. A general financial power of attorney, which covers all decisions
- C. A healthcare power of attorney
- D. A POLST form

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient wants to write down which treatments she would refuse if permanently unconscious, without naming anyone to decide for her. Which document fits?

- A.** A verbal statement to her nurse, which is always legally binding
- B.** A living will
- C.** A healthcare power of attorney
- D.** A do-not-resuscitate order

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A 40-year-old patient at a hospital with a new garden gets little pain relief from codeine after surgery. Testing shows she is a CYP2D6 poor metabolizer. Her grandmother is visiting. What explains this?

- A.** Everyone responds the same to standard doses.
- B.** She is likely exaggerating her pain.
- C.** Poor metabolizers get more active drug, so she needs a lower dose.
- D.** Poor metabolizers convert little codeine to morphine, so pain relief is weak.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A nurse in a primary care office that recently went paperless meets a patient whose mother and maternal aunt both had ovarian cancer in their 40s. The patient runs marathons. What is the nurse's appropriate role?

- A.** Take no action, since cancer on the mother's side can't be passed down.
- B.** Take a three-generation family history and refer her for genetic counseling.
- C.** Order a BRCA test and interpret the results for her.
- D.** Reassure her that her fitness lowers her risk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A 58-year-old with newly diagnosed lung cancer is starting chemotherapy at a cancer center ~~with a new infusion suite~~. She has severe pain and nausea. ~~She is a high school principal~~. Which service can support her now?

Target word: right service **Decides:** She is still receiving curative treatment.

A	Absolute language	Hospice eligibility depends on prognosis and goals.
B	Confusion set	Hospice fits a limited prognosis and comfort-only goals.
C	Correct	Palliative care is available at any stage and with curative care.
D	Inverted operation	Symptom relief should not wait.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Which patient meets typical Medicare hospice eligibility?

Target word: hospice criteria **Decides:** Prognosis of six months or less and comfort-focused goals.

A	Correct	Meets both hospice criteria.
B	Confusion set	Fits palliative care, not hospice.
C	Absolute language	Age alone does not qualify.
D	Adjacent category	Longer than the hospice benchmark.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A 30-year-old at a genetics clinic ~~that recently hired a counselor~~ has a father with Huntington disease, an autosomal dominant condition; her mother is unaffected. ~~She works as a pilot~~. What is her chance of having inherited the variant?

Target word: inheritance risk **Decides:** One affected parent, dominant pattern.

A	Camouflage	Occupation does not affect inheritance.
B	Absolute language	Only one of the father's two copies is passed on.
C	Correct	Each child of a heterozygous affected parent has a 1 in 2 chance.
D	Confusion set	That is the recessive risk for two carriers.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A condition appears in every generation, affects males and females equally, and an affected parent passes it to about half of the children. Which inheritance pattern fits?

Target word: pattern from features **Decides:** Every generation, 50% transmission, both sexes.

A	Adjacent category	Passed only from mothers.
B	Correct	Matches all three features.
C	Confusion set	Mainly affects males.
D	Inverted operation	Recessive traits often skip generations.

5. Answer D Concept 3

Two parents who are both carriers of cystic fibrosis visit a clinic ~~with a colorful new waiting area. They already have one healthy son.~~ What is the chance their next child will have cystic fibrosis?

Target word: risk to next child **Decides:** Carrier × carrier; each pregnancy is independent.

A	Inverted operation	That is the chance of being unaffected.
B	Confusion set	That is the chance of being a carrier.
C	Camouflage	Earlier children do not change the odds.
D	Correct	Each pregnancy carries a 1 in 4 chance.

6. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

Two parents are both carriers of an autosomal recessive condition. What is the chance a child will be a carrier but not affected?

Target word: carrier probability **Decides:** Two of the four Punnett outcomes are carriers.

A	Confusion set	That is the affected risk.
B	Adjacent category	Includes non-carriers with carriers as “unaffected.”
C	Absolute language	Some children inherit no variant copy.
D	Correct	2 of 4 outcomes are heterozygous carriers.

7. Answer A Concept 4

A patient with a strong family history of breast cancer ~~who works at a tech startup~~ asks whether genetic testing could affect her coverage. ~~Her sister is a lawyer.~~ Under GINA, what is protected?

Target word: GINA scope **Decides:** Health insurance and employment only.

A	Correct	GINA's protections are limited to those two areas.
B	Absolute language	Life, disability, and long-term care insurance are excluded.
C	Inverted operation	Life insurance is the kind GINA does not cover.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out health insurance.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A hospice patient at home ~~in a neighborhood with a new park~~ reports distressing breathlessness. ~~The family has three dogs.~~ The care plan is comfort-focused. Which approach aligns with palliative principles?

Target word: comfort-focused response **Decides:** Goal is relief of distress.

A	Correct	Symptom relief is the goal of care.
B	Inverted operation	Conflicts with the comfort-focused plan.
C	Absolute language	Properly dosed opioids are standard for dyspnea at end of life.
D	Camouflage	The pets are not the cause described.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A 75-year-old retired engineer at a clinic ~~that offers free parking~~ wants to name his daughter to make medical decisions if he loses capacity. ~~He also plays chess daily.~~ Which document does he need?

Target word: document type **Decides:** He wants to name a decision-maker.

A	Confusion set	A living will lists wishes but does not name an agent.
B	Absolute language	Financial POAs do not automatically cover health decisions.
C	Correct	It names a person to make medical decisions.
D	Adjacent category	A medical order for current treatment, not an agent appointment.

10. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A patient wants to write down which treatments she would refuse if permanently unconscious, without naming anyone to decide for her. Which document fits?

Target word: document from purpose **Decides:** Written wishes, no agent.

A	Absolute language	Verbal wishes are not always binding.
B	Correct	States treatment wishes in writing.
C	Inverted operation	That names an agent, which she does not want.
D	Adjacent category	A physician's order about CPR only.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A 40-year-old patient ~~at a hospital with a new garden~~ gets little pain relief from codeine after surgery. Testing shows she is a CYP2D6 poor metabolizer. ~~Her grandmother is visiting.~~ What explains this?

Target word: mechanism of response **Decides:** Codeine must be converted to morphine by CYP2D6.

A	Absolute language	Pharmacogenomics shows responses differ.
B	Adjacent category	A genetic explanation fits the data.
C	Inverted operation	For a prodrug, poor metabolism means less active drug.
D	Correct	Codeine is a prodrug needing CYP2D6.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A nurse in a primary care office ~~that recently went paperless~~ meets a patient whose mother and maternal aunt both had ovarian cancer in their 40s. ~~The patient runs marathons.~~ What is the nurse's appropriate role?

Target word: nursing genetics role **Decides:** Red-flag family history.

A	Confusion set	Variants can be inherited from either parent.
B	Correct	Identify risk and refer.
C	Adjacent category	Beyond the generalist nurse's role.
D	Camouflage	Exercise does not change inherited risk.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	9	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Palliative care vs. hospice	Palliative care relieves symptoms at any stage, alongside curative treatment; hospice is for a prognosis of about six months or less when the patient chooses comfort-focused care.	Thinking palliative care means stopping treatment.	Serious illness while still receiving curative treatment.
2	Autosomal dominant inheritance	One copy of the variant causes the trait; each child of an affected heterozygous parent has a 50% chance.	Using the 25% recessive figure.	One affected parent; appears in every generation.
3	Autosomal recessive inheritance	Two carrier parents: each pregnancy has 25% affected, 50% carrier, 25% non-carrier — independent of earlier children.	Thinking a healthy older child changes the next child's odds.	Both parents are carriers.
4	Genetic privacy (GINA)	GINA bars use of genetic information in health insurance and employment decisions, but not in life, disability, or long-term care insurance.	Believing GINA covers all insurance.	A patient worried about testing and insurance.
5	Comfort-focused symptom management	In palliative and hospice care, distressing symptoms such as dyspnea are treated for comfort with ordered measures (e.g., opioids, positioning, a fan) and reassessed.	Withholding symptom relief out of fear it always hastens death.	Distress in a patient whose goal is comfort.
6	Advance directives	A living will states treatment wishes in writing; a healthcare power of attorney names a person to decide if the patient loses capacity.	Mixing up the two documents.	Naming a person vs. listing wishes.
7	Pharmacogenomics	Gene variants change drug metabolism; CYP2D6 poor metabolizers convert little codeine to morphine and get weak relief.	Assuming poor metabolizers get more active drug from a prodrug.	Unexpected drug response plus a genotype result.
8	The nurse's role in genetics	Nurses take a three-generation family history, recognize red flags, and refer for genetic counseling.	Ordering or interpreting tests beyond scope, or dismissing maternal-side history.	Several close relatives with early cancer.

Course scope (public description): Emerging Professional Practice presents a variety of professional nursing specialty areas. Students explore various practice specialties, including palliative care, genetics and genomics, and others. The course provides pathways to specialized nursing practice. All prior courses in the sequence for this program serve as prerequisites for this course. This course is eligible for an In Progress grade. Please see the Grading Scale Policy for more information.